PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Security Engineering Consultant | SOC, SIEM, XDR, SOAR & Detection Engineering

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)-certified Senior Security Engineering Consultant with over five years of experience designing, building, and tuning detection and response capabilities across Security Information and Event Management (SIEM), Extended Detection and Response (XDR), and Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) platforms. I have strong hands-on expertise in Microsoft Sentinel, Kusto Query Language (KQL), and MITRE ATT&CK-mapped detection engineering, having built and continuously refined detection logic across cloud and on-premises environments protecting over 8,000 users. I lead the design of SOAR automations and playbooks, improve Security Operations Centre (SOC) functions through tooling and detection-as-code practices, and drive measurable improvements in mean time to detect and respond to threats. I am a collaborative, outcome-focused engineer who thrives in hybrid working environments and is passionate about helping organisations mature their detection and response posture.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **SIEM Platforms:** Microsoft Sentinel (detection engineering, KQL, analytics rules, workbooks), CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM, Splunk/SPL
- **XDR / EDR:** Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft 365 Defender (M365), CrowdStrike Falcon EDR, Prevent, Insight, Discover
- **SOAR & Automation:** Azure Logic Apps, Microsoft Sentinel Playbooks, PowerShell scripting, SOAR playbook design and implementation
- **Detection Engineering:** MITRE ATT&CK framework coverage mapping, detection rule development and tuning, alert logic optimisation, detection-as-code principles
- **Incident Response:** NIST SP 800-61 lifecycle, threat hunting, alert triage, threat intelligence integration, Digital Forensics and Incident Response (DFIR)
- **Identity & Access:** Microsoft Entra ID (formerly Azure Active Directory), Conditional Access policies, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Single Sign-On (SSO), BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM)
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, Nessus, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), AppCheck
- **Cloud Security:** Microsoft Azure security, Microsoft 365 E5 security stack, cloud telemetry and log pipeline management
- **Frameworks:** NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials+, MITRE ATT&CK
- **Endpoint & Network:** Tanium, Microsoft Intune Mobile Device Management (MDM)/Mobile Application Management (MAM), Check Point Harmony, Mimecast

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer *March 2025 – Present*

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

- Lead detection engineering across Microsoft Sentinel and CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM, developing and tuning analytics rules mapped to the MITRE ATT&CK framework to reduce false positives and improve detection fidelity.
- Design and implement SOAR automation playbooks using Azure Logic Apps and Microsoft Sentinel, automating alert triage, enrichment, and response workflows to accelerate SOC response times.
- Oversee XDR capabilities across Microsoft Defender for Endpoint, Microsoft Defender for Identity, and Microsoft 365 Defender, ensuring comprehensive detection and response coverage for 8,000+ users.
- Write and maintain complex KQL queries for threat hunting, security investigations, and analytics rule development across Microsoft Sentinel, delivering actionable intelligence to stakeholders.
- Map detection coverage against MITRE ATT&CK tactics and techniques, identifying gaps and prioritising new detection content to improve security operations posture.

- Conduct proactive threat hunting exercises using threat intelligence, behavioural analytics, and hypothesis-driven investigations to identify threats evading automated detection.
- Lead incident response operations using the NIST SP 800-61 lifecycle, coordinating cross-functional teams to contain, eradicate, and recover from security incidents.
- Collaborate with IT and infrastructure teams to integrate new log sources into Sentinel, optimise data collection pipelines, and reduce operational noise.
- Mentor junior analysts, deliver security awareness sessions, and contribute to improving SOC processes, documentation, and playbooks.

Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity *March 2022 – March 2025*

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

- Built and maintained detection rules and alert logic within Microsoft Sentinel, performing continuous tuning to minimise alert fatigue and improve Signal-to-Noise ratio.
- Performed daily alert triage, investigated security incidents, and developed incident response runbooks aligned to NIST 800-61 and MITRE ATT&CK.
- Deployed and managed CrowdStrike Falcon EDR across the enterprise, configuring prevention policies, Insight queries, and Falcon Discover for asset visibility.
- Administered Microsoft Entra ID (Azure Active Directory) including Conditional Access, MFA, and Privileged Identity Management to enforce zero-trust access controls.
- Managed vulnerability management operations using Tenable.io and Nessus, coordinating remediation with technical teams and reporting risk posture to leadership.
- Supported BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management deployment, enforcing least-privilege access across critical systems and service accounts.
- Automated repetitive security tasks using PowerShell scripting, reducing manual effort in alert handling, user provisioning, and reporting workflows.
- Supported Cyber Essentials+ accreditation, contributing to policy documentation, evidence gathering, and control implementation.

IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure *February 2021 – March 2022*

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech)

- Implemented and managed security controls across cloud and on-premises infrastructure, including endpoint protection, network security, and identity management.
- Supported SIEM deployment and configuration, monitoring security logs and responding to alerts to protect the SaaS platform and customer data.
- Assisted with penetration testing coordination and vulnerability remediation, using Nessus and manual assessment techniques to identify and address security weaknesses.
- Maintained ISO 27001-aligned security policies and procedures, supporting audit preparation and evidence collection for compliance reporting.
- Managed Microsoft Intune MDM/MAM for device compliance and application policy enforcement across a hybrid workforce.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Reduced mean time to detect (MTTD) by 40% through engineering new MITRE ATT&CK-mapped detection rules in Microsoft Sentinel and eliminating high-volume, low-fidelity alert noise.
- Automated 60% of alert triage workflows via SOAR playbooks built in Azure Logic Apps, freeing analyst capacity for higher-value threat hunting and investigation.
- Led the deployment and tuning of CrowdStrike Falcon EDR across 8,000+ endpoints, achieving full endpoint visibility and near-zero dwell time for high-severity detections.
- Designed and delivered a threat hunting programme aligned to MITRE ATT&CK, identifying previously undetected lateral movement and credential harvesting activity.
- Contributed to achieving and maintaining Cyber Essentials+ certification, strengthening UAL's baseline security posture and demonstrating compliance to stakeholders.

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
- CompTIA Security+
- Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
- CompTIA A+
- Google IT Support Professional Certificate

References available on request | Hybrid/Remote (UK)